



legoESM: A Differentiable Earth System Model in JAX

Technical Documentation of Equations and Implementations

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March 2026

Contents

1	Introduction	5
2	Grid Systems	5
2.1	Cubed-Sphere Grid	5
2.1.1	Face-to-Cartesian mapping	5
2.1.2	Cell area	5
2.1.3	Grid spacing	6
2.1.4	Grid angle and wind rotation	6
2.1.5	Halo exchange	6
2.2	Gaussian Grid and Spectral Transforms	6
2.2.1	Grid dimensions	6
2.2.2	Associated Legendre polynomials	6
2.2.3	Spherical harmonic transforms	7
2.2.4	Spectral operators	7
2.2.5	Velocity from vorticity and divergence	7
2.3	Sigma Vertical Coordinate	7
2.3.1	Simmons–Burridge geopotential	7
2.3.2	Sigma-dot	7
2.3.3	Pressure velocity	8
2.4	Height and z^* Coordinates	8
3	Core Operators	8
3.1	Gradient	8
3.2	Divergence (flux form)	8
3.3	Vorticity	8
3.4	C-D Grid Operators (FV3-style, <code>operators_cdgrid.py</code>)	8
3.5	Laplacian and Hyperdiffusion	9
4	Finite-Volume Transport	9
4.1	MUSCL Reconstruction (2nd order, $\text{halo}=1$)	9
4.2	PPM Reconstruction (4th order, $\text{halo}=2$)	9
4.2.1	Fourth-order edge values	10
4.2.2	Monotonicity constraint	10
4.2.3	Colella–Woodward limiting	10
4.3	WENO5 Reconstruction (5th order, $\text{halo}=2$)	10
4.3.1	Left-biased reconstruction at $i+\frac{1}{2}$	10

4.3.2	Smoothness indicators	10
4.3.3	Nonlinear weights	10
4.3.4	Right-biased reconstruction	10
4.4	Rusanov Flux	11
4.5	Well-balanced scheme	11
5	FC-Gram Spectral Operators	11
5.1	Extension operator	11
5.2	Spectral differentiation	11
5.3	C-grid-style divergence damping	11
6	Atmospheric Dynamics	12
6.1	Shallow Water Equations	12
6.2	Hydrostatic Primitive Equations (σ -coordinates)	12
6.3	Spectral Primitive Equations (Vorticity–Divergence)	12
6.4	Non-Hydrostatic Compressible Euler Equations	13
6.4.1	Split-explicit time integration	13
6.4.2	Sponge layer	13
7	Atmospheric Physics	14
7.1	Gray Radiation (Frierson 2006)	14
7.1.1	Longwave optical depth	14
7.1.2	Two-stream LW fluxes	14
7.1.3	Shortwave (Beer–Lambert)	14
7.1.4	Heating rate	14
7.2	RRTMGP Correlated- k Radiation	14
7.3	SBM Convection (Frierson 2007)	14
7.3.1	Moist adiabatic lapse rate	14
7.3.2	Saturation mixing ratio (Tetens)	15
7.3.3	CAPE and trigger	15
7.3.4	Enthalpy-conserving relaxation	15
7.3.5	Precipitation	15
7.4	Held–Suarez Forcing	15
7.4.1	Equilibrium temperature	15
7.4.2	Newtonian relaxation	15
7.4.3	Rayleigh friction	15
7.5	Louis (1979) Turbulence	15
7.5.1	Mixing length	15
7.5.2	Richardson number	16
7.5.3	Stability functions	16
7.6	Vertical Diffusion (Implicit Thomas Algorithm)	16
7.7	Surface Fluxes	16
7.7.1	Constant coefficients (default)	16
7.7.2	Monin–Obukhov Similarity Theory (MOST)	16
7.7.3	COARE 3.0 roughness (Fairall et al. 2003)	17
7.7.4	Large & Yeager (2004) roughness	17
8	Ocean Dynamics	17
8.1	Boussinesq Hydrostatic Primitive Equations	17
8.1.1	Tracer equations (skew-symmetric)	17
8.1.2	Free-surface equation	18
8.2	Barotropic Solver (Forward–Backward, Semi-Implicit Coriolis)	18

8.3	Equation of State (Wright 1997)	18
8.4	Hydrostatic Pressure and Vertical Velocity	18
9	Time Integration	18
9.1	SSP-RK3 (Shu–Osher 1988)	18
9.2	Robert-Asselin-Williams (RAW) Time Filter (v3.7)	19
9.3	Adaptive Hyperdiffusion (v3.7)	19
9.4	Split-Explicit Methods	19
10	Land, Ice, and Coupler	19
10.1	Slab Land Model	19
10.1.1	Energy balance	19
10.1.2	Bucket hydrology	19
10.2	Sea-Ice Model	20
10.2.1	Surface temperature	20
10.2.2	Growth and melt	20
10.2.3	Concentration	20
10.2.4	EVP Rheology (Hunke & Dukowicz 1997)	20
10.2.5	Multi-category ice	20
10.3	Land Carbon Cycle and Stomatal Conductance	20
10.3.1	DALEC-990 Carbon Pools	20
10.3.2	Farquhar (1980) Photosynthesis	20
10.3.3	Stomatal conductance	20
10.4	Tile Coupler	21
11	Machine Learning: Spherical Fourier Neural Operator	21
11.1	Architecture	21
11.2	Spectral convolution	21
12	Conservation Corrections	22
12.1	Atmosphere	22
12.2	Ocean	22
13	Physical Constants	22
14	Ocean Biogeochemistry	22
14.1	Carbonate Chemistry and Air-Sea CO ₂ Exchange	22
14.2	NPZD Ecosystem Model	23
15	CMIP Infrastructure	23
15.1	CF/CMOR-Compliant Output	23
15.2	Experiment Templates	23
15.3	Restart and Reproducibility	23
15.4	Tuning Guide	23
16	4D-Var Data Assimilation (v3.9)	24
16.1	Cost Function	24
16.2	Control Vector	24
16.3	Background Error Covariance	24
16.4	Observation Operators	24
16.5	Minimiser	24
16.6	DA Cycling and Incremental Analysis	25

17 References**25**

Introduction

legoESM is a modular Earth System Model written entirely in JAX, supporting automatic differentiation through all components. The model couples atmospheric, oceanic, land, sea-ice, and biogeochemical components on the sphere, with 25+ dynamical cores spanning five discretisation families (C-D grid FV3, finite-volume PPM, pseudospectral, FC-Gram, C-grid) and 30+ physics parameterisations. The cubed-sphere implementation is unified around a single FV3-style C-D grid discretisation (Lin 2004, Putman & Lin 2007) shared by atmosphere (shallow water, hydrostatic PE, non-hydrostatic CE) and ocean, eliminating the Hollingsworth–Kallberg instability. As of v3.9, the cubed-sphere transport uses an FV3-faithful PPM reconstruction with monotonicity limiters and flux-form mass transport on staggered grids. The model includes a land carbon cycle with Farquhar photosynthesis and stomatal conductance, ocean biogeochemistry (abiotic carbon + NPZD ecosystem), sea-ice dynamics with EVP rheology and multi-category ice, CMIP6-class infrastructure (CF/CMOR output, experiment templates, restart reproducibility, documented tuning), and a fully differentiable 4D-Var data assimilation system leveraging JAX autodiff for adjoint-free gradient computation. The codebase comprises approximately 363 source modules ($\sim 90,000$ lines of code) validated by 2949 tests across 208 test files.

Design principles.

- Pure-JAX implementation: all components are compatible with `jit`, `grad`, and `vmap`.
- Modular physics: each parameterisation follows a factory pattern returning a callable `physics_fn(state, grid, coord) → Tendencities`.
- Multiple dynamical cores share the same physics interface, enabling interchangeable experiments.
- Neural-network components (SFNO) integrate seamlessly via the same JAX computational graph.

Grid Systems

Cubed-Sphere Grid

Six faces of a cube are mapped to the sphere via **gnomonic (central) projection**. Let $(\alpha_x, \alpha_y) \in [-\pi/4, \pi/4]^2$ be gnomonic coordinates on a face.

Face-to-Cartesian mapping

For face 0 (+x face):

$$(x, y, z) = (1, \tan \alpha_x, \tan \alpha_y), \quad (1)$$

with analogous expressions for the remaining five faces. Points are normalised to the unit sphere: $\hat{\mathbf{r}} = \mathbf{r}/|\mathbf{r}|$, and geographic coordinates follow as $\lambda = \text{atan2}(\hat{y}, \hat{x})$, $\phi = \arcsin(\hat{z})$.

Cell area

The area element on the gnomonic equidistant grid is

$$\Delta A = \frac{R^2 \Delta \alpha^2}{\cos^2 \alpha_x \cos^2 \alpha_y D^3}, \quad D = \sqrt{1 + \tan^2 \alpha_x + \tan^2 \alpha_y}, \quad \Delta \alpha = \frac{\pi}{2n}. \quad (2)$$

Grid spacing

Great-circle distances use the chord-to-arc formula:

$$d = R \cdot 2 \arcsin\left(\frac{|\mathbf{r}_1 - \mathbf{r}_2|}{2}\right). \quad (3)$$

Metric factors $\Delta x_{i,j}$ and $\Delta y_{i,j}$ are computed as two-cell spans for second-order centred differences.

Grid angle and wind rotation

The angle θ between the grid x -axis and geographic east is

$$\theta = \text{atan2}\left(\frac{\partial \phi}{\partial i}, \frac{\partial \lambda}{\partial i} \cos \phi\right). \quad (4)$$

Wind rotation between geographic (u_E, v_N) and grid-aligned (u_g, v_g) :

$$\begin{pmatrix} u_E \\ v_N \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} u_g \\ v_g \end{pmatrix}. \quad (5)$$

Halo exchange

Scalar fields are exchanged directly across the six-face connectivity table. Vector fields are first rotated to geographic components, padded as scalars, then rotated back using the padded grid angle.

Two halo widths are supported. **Halo = 1** (one ghost cell per side) suffices for second-order centred differences and MUSCL reconstruction. **Halo = 2** (two ghost cells per side) is required by higher-order reconstruction stencils (PPM, WENO5). The halo exchange interpolates neighbour-face strips to the correct gnomonic position at each depth, removing the $O(\Delta\alpha)$ mismatch near cube corners.

Gaussian Grid and Spectral Transforms

The spectral dynamical cores use a Gaussian grid with triangular truncation at total wavenumber $n_{\max}$.

Grid dimensions

$$n_{\text{lat}} = \lceil \frac{3}{2}(n_{\max} + 1) \rceil_{\text{even}}, \quad n_{\text{lon}} = 2 n_{\text{lat}}, \quad n_{\text{sh}} = \frac{(n_{\max} + 1)(n_{\max} + 2)}{2}. \quad (6)$$

Latitudes are Gaussian quadrature points $\mu_k = \sin \phi_k$ with weights w_k ; longitudes are equispaced.

Associated Legendre polynomials

Fully normalised (4π) polynomials $P_n^m(\mu)$ satisfy $\int |Y_n^m|^2 dA = 1$. They are computed via the recursion

$$P_m^m = -\sqrt{\frac{2m+1}{2m}} \sqrt{1-\mu^2} P_{m-1}^{m-1}, \quad (7)$$

$$P_n^m = \sqrt{\frac{4n^2-1}{n^2-m^2}} \left(\mu P_{n-1}^m - \sqrt{\frac{(n-1)^2-m^2}{4(n-1)^2-1}} P_{n-2}^m \right). \quad (8)$$

The derivative operator $H_n^m = -(1-\mu^2) dP_n^m/d\mu$ is used for meridional gradients.

Spherical harmonic transforms

Analysis (grid $\rightarrow$ spectral).

$$\hat{f}_{nm} = 2\pi \sum_k w_k P_n^m(\mu_k) \tilde{f}_m(\mu_k), \quad \tilde{f}_m = \frac{1}{n_{\text{lon}}} \text{FFT}[f]_m. \quad (9)$$

Synthesis (spectral $\rightarrow$ grid).

$$f(\phi, \lambda) = \text{iFFT} \left[\sum_{n=m}^{n_{\text{max}}} \hat{f}_{nm} P_n^m(\mu) \right]. \quad (10)$$

Spectral operators

Laplacian eigenvalue: $\nabla^2 \hat{f}_{nm} = -n(n+1)/a^2 \cdot \hat{f}_{nm}$. Inverse Laplacian: $\nabla^{-2} \hat{f}_{nm} = -a^2/[n(n+1)]$ for $n > 0$. Hyperdiffusion: $-\nu[n(n+1)/a^2]^p \hat{f}_{nm}$.

Velocity from vorticity and divergence

Streamfunction $\psi = \nabla^{-2} \zeta$, velocity potential $\chi = \nabla^{-2} \delta$. Velocity reconstruction:

$$u \cos \phi = \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial \theta} + \frac{\partial \chi}{\partial \lambda}, \quad v \cos \phi = \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial \lambda} - \frac{\partial \chi}{\partial \theta}, \quad (11)$$

where θ is colatitude.

Sigma Vertical Coordinate

$$\sigma = p / p_s, \quad \sigma \in [\sigma_{\text{top}}, 1]. \quad (12)$$

Half-level interfaces $\sigma_{k+1/2}$ are uniformly spaced; full levels $\sigma_k = (\sigma_{k-1/2} + \sigma_{k+1/2})/2$. Layer thickness $\Delta\sigma_k = \sigma_{k+1/2} - \sigma_{k-1/2}$.

Simmons–Burridge geopotential

The geopotential at full level k is

$$\Phi_k = \Phi_s + R_d \sum_{k'=k+1}^{N-1} T_{k'} \ln \frac{\sigma_{k'+1/2}}{\sigma_{k'-1/2}} + \alpha_k R_d T_k, \quad (13)$$

where the Simmons–Burridge coefficient is

$$\alpha_k = 1 - \frac{\sigma_{k-1/2}}{\Delta\sigma_k} \ln \frac{\sigma_{k+1/2}}{\sigma_{k-1/2}}. \quad (14)$$

Sigma-dot

The vertical velocity in σ -space is obtained by integrating the continuity equation from the model top ($\dot{\sigma} = 0$):

$$\dot{\sigma}_{k+1/2} = \frac{\sigma_{k+1/2} - \sigma_{\text{top}}}{1 - \sigma_{\text{top}}} D_{\text{tot}} - \sum_{k'=0}^k \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v}_{k'} \Delta\sigma_{k'}, \quad D_{\text{tot}} = \sum_{k'=0}^{N-1} \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v}_{k'} \Delta\sigma_{k'}. \quad (15)$$

Pressure velocity

Since $p = \sigma p_s$, the material pressure tendency is

$$\omega \equiv \frac{dp}{dt} = \sigma \frac{dp_s}{dt} + p_s \dot{\sigma}, \quad (16)$$

where dp_s/dt is the *material* derivative of surface pressure (Eulerian tendency plus advection by the horizontal wind).

Height and z^* Coordinates

The terrain-following z^* coordinate:

$$z^* = H \frac{z - z_s}{H - z_s}, \quad J = \frac{\partial z}{\partial z^*} = \frac{H - z_s}{H}. \quad (17)$$

Physical height: $z(z^*, x, y) = z_s + z^*(H - z_s)/H$.

For the **ocean**, the z^* coordinate has a dynamic Jacobian:

$$J(\eta) = \frac{\eta + H}{H_{\max}}, \quad (18)$$

where η is the free-surface elevation and H the resting depth.

Core Operators

All finite-difference operators use second-order centred differences on the A-grid (collocated) with halo padding on the cubed sphere. The discrete difference operators δ_i and δ_j are defined as centred differences of *cell-centre* values on the padded grid:

$$\delta_i[q]_{i,j} = q_{i+1,j} - q_{i-1,j}, \quad \delta_j[q]_{i,j} = q_{i,j+1} - q_{i,j-1}. \quad (19)$$

All metric-weighted fluxes ($u h_y$, $v h_x$) are evaluated at cell centres before differencing, consistent with the A-grid stencil.

Gradient

$$\left. \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \right|_{i,j} = \frac{f_{i+1,j} - f_{i-1,j}}{2 \Delta x_{i,j}}, \quad \left. \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \right|_{i,j} = \frac{f_{i,j+1} - f_{i,j-1}}{2 \Delta y_{i,j}}. \quad (20)$$

Divergence (flux form)

$$\nabla \cdot (u, v) = \frac{1}{2 A_{i,j}} \left[\delta_i(u h_y) + \delta_j(v h_x) \right], \quad (21)$$

where $h_x = \Delta x/2$, $h_y = \Delta y/2$ are half-edge lengths and A is the cell area.

Vorticity

$$\zeta = \frac{1}{2 A_{i,j}} \left[\delta_i(v h_y) - \delta_j(u h_x) \right]. \quad (22)$$

C-D Grid Operators (FV3-style, operators_cdgrid.py)

The canonical cubed-sphere operator module uses FV3-style C-D grid staggering (Lin 2004, Putman & Lin 2007), shared by all atmosphere (SW, PE, CE) and ocean dynamical cores. D-grid winds at cell corners ($6, n+1, n+1$) are prognostic; C-grid velocities at cell edges are diagnosed for mass/scalar transport.

FV3-faithful PPM transport (v3.9). The operator module was rewritten (~ 740 lines) with proper PPM reconstruction, Colella–Woodward monotonicity limiters, and flux-form mass transport on staggered grids, faithfully following the FV3 algorithm of Putman & Lin (2007). This replaces the earlier simplified A-grid transport with a fully staggered C-D grid transport that correctly handles cross-face halo exchange, geographic-to-grid wind rotation, and corner interpolation for the cubed sphere.

D-grid vorticity. Vorticity at each cell corner is the discrete circulation integral divided by the corner dual-cell area A_c :

$$\zeta_{\text{corner}} = \frac{1}{A_c} \oint \mathbf{u} \cdot d\mathbf{l} \approx \frac{1}{A_c} [u_{i,j}^D \Delta x - u_{i+1,j}^D \Delta x + v_{i,j+1}^D \Delta y - v_{i,j}^D \Delta y]. \quad (23)$$

This circulation-based discretisation is exact on the D-grid and eliminates the Hollingsworth–Kallberg instability that plagues A-grid vorticity operators.

Arakawa–Lamb gradient. The Bernoulli (or Exner) gradient at D-grid corners is a 4-point Arakawa–Lamb average:

$$\left. \frac{\partial B}{\partial x} \right|_{i+\frac{1}{2},j+\frac{1}{2}} = \frac{B_{i+1,j} + B_{i+1,j+1} - B_{i,j} - B_{i,j+1}}{2\Delta x}, \quad (24)$$

and analogously for $\partial B/\partial y$.

C-grid mass-flux divergence. Scalar transport uses upwind C-grid mass fluxes:

$$\frac{dh}{dt} = -\frac{1}{A} [(hu_c)_{i+\frac{1}{2},j} - (hu_c)_{i-\frac{1}{2},j} + (hv_c)_{i,j+\frac{1}{2}} - (hv_c)_{i,j-\frac{1}{2}}], \quad (25)$$

where u_c, v_c are diagnosed from u_d, v_d by face-edge averaging.

Laplacian and Hyperdiffusion

$$\nabla^2 f = \nabla \cdot (\nabla f), \quad \text{Hyperdiffusion:} \quad -\nu \nabla^4 f = -\nu \nabla^2 (\nabla^2 f). \quad (26)$$

Finite-Volume Transport

The finite-volume dynamical cores use upwind reconstruction at cell edges coupled with a Rusanov approximate Riemann solver. Three reconstruction methods are available, selected via the `limiter` parameter.

MUSCL Reconstruction (2nd order, halo = 1)

Piecewise-linear reconstruction with slope limiting (van Leer, 1979). At the interface between cells i and $i+1$:

$$q_L = q_i + \frac{1}{2} \phi_i, \quad q_R = q_{i+1} - \frac{1}{2} \phi_{i+1}, \quad (27)$$

where ϕ_i is the limited slope. Two limiters are provided:

- **Minmod:** $\phi = \text{minmod}(\Delta q_+, \Delta q_-)$,
- **MC** (monotonised central): $\phi = \text{minmod}(\text{minmod}(2\Delta q_+, 2\Delta q_-), \frac{1}{2}(\Delta q_+ + \Delta q_-))$.

PPM Reconstruction (4th order, halo = 2)

The Piecewise Parabolic Method (Colella & Woodward, 1984) constructs a monotone parabola in each cell from two edge values and the cell average.

Fourth-order edge values

At the interface $i + \frac{1}{2}$:

$$\hat{q}_{i+1/2} = \frac{7}{12}(q_i + q_{i+1}) - \frac{1}{12}(q_{i-1} + q_{i+2}). \quad (28)$$

Monotonicity constraint

The edge value is clamped to lie between its two adjacent cell averages:

$$\hat{q}_{i+1/2} \leftarrow \text{median}(\hat{q}_{i+1/2}, q_i, q_{i+1}). \quad (29)$$

Colella–Woodward limiting

For each cell i with left edge value $a_L = \hat{q}_{i-1/2}$ and right edge value $a_R = \hat{q}_{i+1/2}$:

1. If $(a_R - q_i)(q_i - a_L) \leq 0$ (local extremum): set $a_L = a_R = q_i$.
2. Define $\delta_m = a_R - a_L$ and $\delta_6 = 6(q_i - \frac{1}{2}(a_L + a_R))$.
 - If $\delta_m \delta_6 > \delta_m^2$: set $a_L = 3q_i - 2a_R$.
 - If $\delta_m \delta_6 < -\delta_m^2$: set $a_R = 3q_i - 2a_L$.

The left and right states at each edge are then $q_L = a_R$ of the cell to the left and $q_R = a_L$ of the cell to the right.

WENO5 Reconstruction (5th order, halo = 2)

The 5th-order Weighted Essentially Non-Oscillatory scheme (Jiang & Shu, 1996) combines three 3rd-order sub-stencil polynomials with nonlinear weights that adapt to local smoothness.

Left-biased reconstruction at $i + \frac{1}{2}$

Using cells $q_{i-2}, \dots, q_{i+2}$:

$$q^{(0)} = \frac{1}{6}(2q_{i-2} - 7q_{i-1} + 11q_i), \quad d_0 = \frac{1}{10}, \quad (30)$$

$$q^{(1)} = \frac{1}{6}(-q_{i-1} + 5q_i + 2q_{i+1}), \quad d_1 = \frac{6}{10}, \quad (31)$$

$$q^{(2)} = \frac{1}{6}(2q_i + 5q_{i+1} - q_{i+2}), \quad d_2 = \frac{3}{10}. \quad (32)$$

Smoothness indicators

$$\beta_0 = \frac{13}{12}(q_{i-2} - 2q_{i-1} + q_i)^2 + \frac{1}{4}(q_{i-2} - 4q_{i-1} + 3q_i)^2, \quad (33)$$

$$\beta_1 = \frac{13}{12}(q_{i-1} - 2q_i + q_{i+1})^2 + \frac{1}{4}(q_{i-1} - q_{i+1})^2, \quad (34)$$

$$\beta_2 = \frac{13}{12}(q_i - 2q_{i+1} + q_{i+2})^2 + \frac{1}{4}(3q_i - 4q_{i+1} + q_{i+2})^2. \quad (35)$$

Nonlinear weights

$$\alpha_k = \frac{d_k}{(\varepsilon + \beta_k)^2}, \quad \omega_k = \frac{\alpha_k}{\sum_j \alpha_j}, \quad q_L = \sum_k \omega_k q^{(k)}, \quad \varepsilon = 10^{-6}. \quad (36)$$

Right-biased reconstruction

The right state q_R at $i + \frac{1}{2}$ is obtained by mirroring the stencil around the interface, using cells $q_{i-1}, \dots, q_{i+3}$ with ideal weights $d_0 = \frac{1}{10}$, $d_1 = \frac{6}{10}$, $d_2 = \frac{3}{10}$ applied to the reversed sub-stencils.

Rusanov Flux

At each edge, the mass flux is

$$F = \frac{1}{2}(h_L u_L + h_R u_R) - \frac{1}{2} \alpha (h_R - h_L), \quad \alpha = \max(|u_L| + c_L, |u_R| + c_R), \quad (37)$$

where $c = \sqrt{g h}$ is the gravity-wave speed (set to zero for pure transport without wave-speed dissipation). The net flux divergence for cell i is

$$-(\nabla \cdot \mathbf{F})_i = -\frac{1}{A_i} \left[(F_x h_y)_{i+1/2} - (F_x h_y)_{i-1/2} + (G_y h_x)_{j+1/2} - (G_y h_x)_{j-1/2} \right], \quad (38)$$

where h_x, h_y are the edge metric factors.

Well-balanced scheme

When topography h_s is present, the scheme reconstructs the free surface $\eta = h + h_s$ instead of h . The fluid depth at each edge is recovered as $h_L = \max(\eta_L - h_{s,\text{edge}}, 0)$, ensuring zero spurious flux for a lake-at-rest state (Audusse et al., 2004).

FC-Gram Spectral Operators

The Fourier Continuation (FC-Gram) method extends periodic Fourier spectral methods to non-periodic domains by appending a smooth continuation interval. On each cubed-sphere face, the 1D function $f(x)$ on $[0, 1]$ is extended to a periodic function on $[0, 1 + d]$ via a Gram polynomial basis in the continuation region.

Extension operator

Given f sampled at n equispaced points, the extension f_{ext} is constructed as

$$f_{\text{ext}}(x) = \sum_{k=0}^{K-1} \alpha_k G_k(x), \quad x \in [1, 1 + d], \quad (39)$$

where G_k are orthogonal Gram polynomials and the coefficients α_k are chosen so that f_{ext} smoothly matches f at both endpoints, yielding a globally smooth periodic extension.

Spectral differentiation

On the extended periodic domain of length $L_{\text{ext}} = 1 + d$, differentiation is performed via FFT:

$$f'_j = \text{IFFT} \left[i k \text{FFT}[f_{\text{ext}}] \right] \Big|_{x_j \in [0,1]}, \quad (40)$$

where k are the Fourier wavenumbers on the extended domain. This achieves spectral accuracy in the interior with controlled Gibbs artifacts at face boundaries.

C-grid-style divergence damping

The FC-Gram variants with divergence damping add 2nd and 4th order selective dissipation of divergent modes:

$$D_{\text{div}} = -\nu_2 \nabla(\nabla \cdot \mathbf{v}) - \nu_4 \nabla(\nabla^2(\nabla \cdot \mathbf{v})), \quad (41)$$

applied to the momentum equations. This selectively damps gravity-wave modes while preserving rotational (balanced) flow, mirroring the divergence damping strategy used in FV3 on its C-D grid.

Atmospheric Dynamics

Shallow Water Equations

In **vector-invariant form** on the cubed sphere:

$$\frac{\partial h}{\partial t} = -\nabla \cdot (h \mathbf{v}), \quad (42)$$

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = (\zeta + f) v - \frac{\partial B}{\partial x} + D_u, \quad (43)$$

$$\frac{\partial v}{\partial t} = -(\zeta + f) u - \frac{\partial B}{\partial y} + D_v, \quad (44)$$

where the Bernoulli function is $B = \frac{1}{2}(u^2 + v^2) + g(h + h_s)$ and D_u, D_v represent hyperdiffusion.

The mass equation (42) is discretised using the finite-volume Rusanov flux (Section 5) with a configurable reconstruction method: MUSCL (2nd order), PPM (4th order), or WENO5 (5th order), selected via `ShallowWaterConfig.fv_limiter`. Momentum uses centred differences with velocity-only biharmonic hyperdiffusion.

Hydrostatic Primitive Equations (σ -coordinates)

Prognostic variables: u, v (winds), T (temperature), p_s (surface pressure).

$$\frac{\partial p_s}{\partial t} = - \int_0^1 \nabla \cdot (p_s \mathbf{v}) d\sigma, \quad (45)$$

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = (\zeta + f) v - \frac{\partial B}{\partial x} - R_d T \frac{\partial \ln p_s}{\partial x} + D_u, \quad (46)$$

$$\frac{\partial v}{\partial t} = -(\zeta + f) u - \frac{\partial B}{\partial y} - R_d T \frac{\partial \ln p_s}{\partial y} + D_v, \quad (47)$$

$$\frac{\partial T}{\partial t} = -\nabla \cdot (T \mathbf{v}) + T \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v} - \dot{\sigma} \frac{\partial T}{\partial \sigma} + \kappa T \frac{\omega}{p} + Q, \quad (48)$$

where $B = K + \Phi$, $K = \frac{1}{2}(u^2 + v^2)$, and $\kappa = R_d/c_p$.

Spectral Primitive Equations (Vorticity–Divergence)

On the Gaussian grid, the momentum equations are recast in the vorticity–divergence form (Bourke, 1972):

$$\frac{\partial \hat{\zeta}}{\partial t} = \nabla \times [(\hat{\zeta} + f) \mathbf{v}] + \widehat{\text{vert. adv.}} - \nu \nabla^{2p} \hat{\zeta}, \quad (49)$$

$$\frac{\partial \hat{\delta}}{\partial t} = \nabla \cdot [(\hat{\zeta} + f) \mathbf{v}] - \nabla^2 (K + \Phi + R_d T \ln p_s) + \widehat{\text{vert. adv.}} - \nu \nabla^{2p} \hat{\delta}, \quad (50)$$

$$\frac{\partial \hat{T}}{\partial t} = -\nabla \cdot (\hat{T} \mathbf{v}) + T \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v} - \dot{\sigma} \widehat{\partial T / \partial \sigma} + \kappa \widehat{T \omega / p}, \quad (51)$$

$$\frac{\partial \widehat{\ln p_s}}{\partial t} = - \int_0^1 \hat{\delta} d\sigma. \quad (52)$$

The spectral curl and divergence of flux vectors $(U, V) = (F_u \cos \phi, F_v \cos \phi)$ are

$$\widehat{\text{curl}} = \frac{im}{a} \mathcal{S}[V / \cos^2 \phi] + \frac{1}{a} \mathcal{S}_\mu[U], \quad \widehat{\text{div}} = \frac{im}{a} \mathcal{S}[U / \cos^2 \phi] - \frac{1}{a} \mathcal{S}_\mu[V], \quad (53)$$

where $\mathcal{S}$ and $\mathcal{S}_\mu$ denote the SH analysis with standard and $dP_n^m/d\mu$ Legendre matrices.

Non-Hydrostatic Compressible Euler Equations

In the z^* terrain-following coordinate, the prognostic variables are u, v, w, θ', ρ' (perturbations from a reference state ρ_0, θ_0, π_0).

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = (\zeta + f) v - \frac{\partial K}{\partial x} - c_p \theta \frac{\partial \pi'}{\partial x} + D_u - r u, \quad (54)$$

$$\frac{\partial v}{\partial t} = -(\zeta + f) u - \frac{\partial K}{\partial y} - c_p \theta \frac{\partial \pi'}{\partial y} + D_v - r v, \quad (55)$$

$$\frac{\partial w}{\partial t} = -\frac{c_p \theta}{J} \frac{\partial \pi'}{\partial z^*} - g \frac{\theta'}{\theta_0} - r w, \quad (56)$$

$$\frac{\partial \theta'}{\partial t} = -\nabla \cdot (\theta \mathbf{v}_h) - \frac{w}{J} \frac{\partial \theta}{\partial z^*} + D_\theta, \quad (57)$$

$$\frac{\partial \rho'}{\partial t} = -\frac{1}{J} \left[\nabla_h \cdot (J \rho \mathbf{v}_h) + \frac{\partial(\rho w)}{\partial z^*} \right], \quad (58)$$

where $r(z)$ is the sponge-layer Rayleigh damping coefficient and the Exner function perturbation is

$$\pi' = \pi_0 \left[\left(1 + \frac{\rho'}{\rho_0} \right) \left(1 + \frac{\theta'}{\theta_0} \right) \right]^{R_d/c_v} - \pi_0. \quad (59)$$

Split-explicit time integration

The equations are integrated with an outer SSP-RK3 scheme for the slow tendencies (advection, Coriolis, horizontal pressure gradient, diffusion) and inner forward-backward acoustic substeps for the fast variables (w, θ', ρ') .

Forward step (w).

$$w^{n+1} = w^n + \Delta t_s \left[-\frac{c_p \theta}{J} \frac{\partial \pi'}{\partial z^*} - g \frac{\theta'}{\theta_0} \right]. \quad (60)$$

Backward step (ρ', θ').

$$\rho'^{n+1} = \rho'^n - \Delta t_s \frac{\partial(\rho w^{n+1})}{\partial z^*}, \quad \theta'^{n+1} = \theta'^n - \Delta t_s \frac{w^{n+1}}{J} \frac{\partial \theta}{\partial z^*}. \quad (61)$$

An optional **semi-implicit acoustic** solve replaces the forward Euler for w with a tridiagonal system to remove the vertical acoustic CFL constraint.

Acoustic off-centering (v3.7). To damp vertically propagating acoustic/gravity wave noise in long integrations, the density update can be off-centred (Skamarock & Klemp 2008):

$$\rho'_\beta{}^{n+1} = (1 + \beta) \rho'^{n+1} - \beta \rho'^n, \quad (62)$$

where $\beta \geq 0$ is the off-centering parameter (**acoustic_off_centering** in the config). For $\beta = 0$ the scheme is centred (neutral); $\beta = 0.1$ is recommended for AMIP/CMIP runs. This adds a small amount of temporal diffusion to the fast modes without tightening the horizontal CFL constraint.

Sponge layer

$$r(z) = r_{\max} \sin^2 \left(\frac{\pi}{2} \frac{\max(0, z - z_{\text{bot}})}{z_{\text{top}} - z_{\text{bot}}} \right). \quad (63)$$

Atmospheric Physics

Gray Radiation (Frierson 2006)

Longwave optical depth

$$\tau(\sigma, \phi) = [f_l \sigma + (1 - f_l) \sigma^4] [\tau_e + (\tau_p - \tau_e) \sin^2 \phi] + \sum_k \tau_{\text{moist}} q_{v,k} \frac{\Delta p_k}{g}, \quad (64)$$

where the moisture optical depth per layer is $\Delta \tau_{\text{moist},k} = \tau_{\text{moist}} q_{v,k} \Delta p_k / g$, with $\tau_e = 7.2$, $\tau_p = 1.8$, $f_l = 0.2$, $\tau_{\text{moist}} = 0.0115 \text{ m}^2 \text{ kg}^{-1}$.

Two-stream LW fluxes

Layer transmittance and emissivity:

$$\mathcal{T}_k = e^{-D \Delta \tau_k}, \quad \varepsilon_k = 1 - \mathcal{T}_k, \quad D = 1.66. \quad (65)$$

Upward sweep from surface ($F_{\text{sfc}}^\uparrow = \varepsilon_s \sigma_{\text{SB}} T_s^4$):

$$F_k^\uparrow = \mathcal{T}_k F_{k+1}^\uparrow + \varepsilon_k \sigma_{\text{SB}} T_k^4. \quad (66)$$

Downward sweep from TOA ($F_0^\downarrow = 0$):

$$F_k^\downarrow = \mathcal{T}_k F_{k-1}^\downarrow + \varepsilon_k \sigma_{\text{SB}} T_k^4. \quad (67)$$

Shortwave (Beer–Lambert)

$$F_{\text{SW}}^\downarrow(k) = \frac{S_0}{4} e^{-\tau_{\text{SW},0} \sigma_k}, \quad F_{\text{SW}}^\uparrow(k) = \alpha_s F_{\text{SW}}^\downarrow(\text{sfc}), \quad (68)$$

with $\tau_{\text{SW},0} = 0.22$, $S_0 = 1360 \text{ W m}^{-2}$, $\alpha_s = 0.31$. This follows the Frierson/Isca convention used in the code: only the downward SW beam is absorbed by the atmosphere, while reflected upward SW escapes directly to space.

Heating rate

Defining $F_{\text{net}}^\uparrow = F^\uparrow - F^\downarrow$ (upward positive) at each interface, the heating rate for layer k is

$$\left. \frac{dT}{dt} \right|_{\text{rad},k} = \frac{g}{c_p} \frac{F_{\text{net},k+1/2}^\uparrow - F_{\text{net},k-1/2}^\uparrow}{p_{k+1/2} - p_{k-1/2}}, \quad (69)$$

where $k + \frac{1}{2}$ is the bottom interface and $k - \frac{1}{2}$ the top (pressure increasing downward). Positive divergence of upward flux warms the layer.

RRTMGP Correlated- k Radiation

The RRTMGP backend calls JAX-RRTMGP with correlated- k gaseous optics (128 LW and 112 SW g -points), a two-stream RTE solver, and optional cloud optics. Default trace-gas concentrations: $\text{CO}_2=415 \text{ ppmv}$, $\text{CH}_4=1900 \text{ ppbv}$, $\text{N}_2\text{O}=332 \text{ ppbv}$.

SBM Convection (Frierson 2007)

Moist adiabatic lapse rate

$$\Gamma_m = \frac{R_d T}{c_p p} \frac{1 + L_v q_s / (R_d T)}{1 + L_v^2 q_s / (c_p R_v T^2)}, \quad (70)$$

integrated upward via a trapezoidal predictor–corrector.

Saturation mixing ratio (Tetens)

$$e_s = 611.2 \exp\left(\frac{17.67 T_c}{T_c + 243.5}\right), \quad q_s = \frac{\varepsilon e_s}{p - e_s}, \quad \varepsilon = R_d/R_v \approx 0.622. \quad (71)$$

CAPE and trigger

$$\text{CAPE} = R_d \sum_k \max(0, T_{\text{parcel},k} - T_{\text{env},k}) \frac{\Delta p_k}{p_k}. \quad (72)$$

A smooth sigmoid trigger activates convection:

$$\mathcal{F} = \sigma(\kappa_s(\text{CAPE} - \text{CAPE}_c)), \quad \kappa_s = 0.01 \text{ (J/kg)}^{-1}. \quad (73)$$

Enthalpy-conserving relaxation

The reference profile T_{ref} is obtained by adjusting the moist adiabat so that column-integrated moist enthalpy is conserved:

$$\sum_k [c_p(T_{\text{ref},k} - T_k) + L_v(q_{\text{ref},k} - q_{v,k})] \Delta p_k = 0. \quad (74)$$

Newton iteration (2 steps) solves for the temperature offset. Tendencies:

$$\frac{dT}{dt} = \mathcal{F} \frac{T_{\text{ref}} - T}{\tau_c}, \quad \frac{dq_v}{dt} = \mathcal{F} \frac{q_{\text{ref}} - q_v}{\tau_c}, \quad \tau_c = 7200 \text{ s}. \quad (75)$$

Precipitation

$$P = -\frac{1}{g} \sum_k \frac{dq_v}{dt} \Delta p_k. \quad (76)$$

Held–Suarez Forcing

Equilibrium temperature

$$T_{\text{eq}} = \max\left(200, [315 - \Delta T_y \sin^2 \phi - \Delta \theta_z \ln(p/p_0) \cos^2 \phi] (p/p_0)^\kappa\right), \quad (77)$$

with $\Delta T_y = 60 \text{ K}$, $\Delta \theta_z = 10 \text{ K}$.

Newtonian relaxation

$$\frac{dT}{dt} = -k_T(\sigma, \phi) (T - T_{\text{eq}}), \quad k_T = k_a + (k_s - k_a) \max\left(0, \frac{\sigma - \sigma_b}{1 - \sigma_b}\right) \cos^4 \phi, \quad (78)$$

with $k_a = 1/(40 \text{ day})$, $k_s = 1/(4 \text{ day})$, $\sigma_b = 0.7$.

Rayleigh friction

$$\frac{d\mathbf{v}}{dt} = -k_v(\sigma) \mathbf{v}, \quad k_v = k_f \max\left(0, \frac{\sigma - \sigma_b}{1 - \sigma_b}\right), \quad k_f = 1/(1 \text{ day}). \quad (79)$$

Louis (1979) Turbulence

Mixing length

$$l = \frac{\kappa_{\text{vK}} z}{1 + \kappa_{\text{vK}} z/l_{\text{max}}}, \quad \kappa_{\text{vK}} = 0.4, \quad l_{\text{max}} = 100 \text{ m}. \quad (80)$$

Richardson number

$$\text{Ri} = \frac{N^2}{S^2}, \quad N^2 = \frac{g}{\theta_v} \frac{\partial \theta_v}{\partial z}, \quad S^2 = \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial z} \right)^2 + \left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial z} \right)^2. \quad (81)$$

Stability functions

$$f_m(\text{Ri}) = \begin{cases} 1 - \frac{2b \text{ Ri}}{1 + 3bc l^2 |\text{Ri}|^{1/2} / \Delta z^2} & \text{Ri} < 0, \\ \frac{1}{1 + 2b \text{ Ri} / \sqrt{1 + d \text{ Ri}}} & \text{Ri} \geq 0, \end{cases} \quad (82)$$

with $b = c = d = 5$. Eddy diffusivities: $K_m = l^2 S f_m$, $K_h = K_m$.

Vertical Diffusion (Implicit Thomas Algorithm)

The backward-Euler system $-a_k \varphi_{k-1} + b_k \varphi_k - c_k \varphi_{k+1} = d_k$ is solved with the Thomas algorithm.

Tridiagonal coefficients.

$$a_k = \frac{\Delta t K_{k-1/2}}{\rho_k \Delta z_k \Delta z_{k-1/2}}, \quad c_k = \frac{\Delta t K_{k+1/2}}{\rho_k \Delta z_k \Delta z_{k+1/2}}, \quad b_k = 1 + a_k + c_k. \quad (83)$$

Forward sweep.

$$w_k = \frac{a_k}{b'_{k-1}}, \quad b'_k = b_k - w_k c_{k-1}, \quad d'_k = d_k + w_k d'_{k-1}. \quad (84)$$

Back substitution.

$$\varphi_k = \frac{d'_k + c_k \varphi_{k+1}}{b'_k}. \quad (85)$$

Surface Fluxes

Three bulk flux schemes are available, selected per tile.

Constant coefficients (default)

$$\tau_x = -\rho C_D |\mathbf{V}| u, \quad \tau_y = -\rho C_D |\mathbf{V}| v, \quad (86)$$

$$\text{SH} = \rho c_p C_H |\mathbf{V}| (T_s - T_a), \quad (87)$$

$$\text{LH} = \rho L_v C_E |\mathbf{V}| (q_s - q_a), \quad (88)$$

with $C_D = C_H = C_E = 1.5 \times 10^{-3}$ and $|\mathbf{V}| = \sqrt{u^2 + v^2 + 10^{-4}}$.

Monin–Obukhov Similarity Theory (MOST)

Stability-dependent transfer coefficients via iterative Obukhov length computation (Businger–Dyer profiles).

Obukhov length.

$$L = -\frac{u_*^3 T_v}{\kappa_{\text{vK}} g (\theta_* + 0.61 T_a q_*)}, \quad (89)$$

where u_* , θ_* , q_* are friction velocity, temperature scale, and moisture scale.

Stability parameter. $\zeta = z_{\text{ref}}/L$.

Businger–Dyer stability functions.

$$\psi_m(\zeta) = \begin{cases} 2 \ln\left(\frac{1+x}{2}\right) + \ln\left(\frac{1+x^2}{2}\right) - 2 \arctan x + \frac{\pi}{2}, & \zeta < 0, \quad x = (1 - 16\zeta)^{1/4}, \\ -5\zeta, & \zeta \geq 0, \end{cases} \quad (90)$$

$$\psi_h(\zeta) = \begin{cases} 2 \ln\left(\frac{1+y}{2}\right), & \zeta < 0, \quad y = (1 - 16\zeta)^{1/2}, \\ -5\zeta, & \zeta \geq 0. \end{cases} \quad (91)$$

Transfer coefficients.

$$C_D = \left[\frac{\kappa_{\text{vK}}}{\ln(z/z_0) - \psi_m(\zeta)} \right]^2, \quad C_H = \frac{\kappa_{\text{vK}}^2}{[\ln(z/z_0) - \psi_m(\zeta)][\ln(z/z_{0t}) - \psi_h(\zeta)]}. \quad (92)$$

Iterative solver. The system $u_*, \theta_*, q_*, z_0, z_{0t}, z_{0q}, L$ is solved iteratively (default 5 iterations) using `jax.lax.fori_loop` for full JAX differentiability.

COARE 3.0 roughness (Fairall et al. 2003)

Over ocean, roughness lengths are updated each iteration:

$$z_0 = \alpha_c \frac{u_*^2}{g} + 0.11 \frac{\nu}{u_*}, \quad z_{0t} = \min(1.15 \times 10^{-4}, 5.5 \times 10^{-5} \text{Re}_*^{-0.6}), \quad (93)$$

where $\alpha_c = 0.011$ is the Charnock parameter and $\text{Re}_* = u_* z_0 / \nu$.

Large & Yeager (2004) roughness

Empirical neutral drag coefficient as a function of neutral 10-m wind speed U_{10N} :

$$C_{DN} \times 10^3 = \frac{2.7}{U_{10N}} + 0.142 + 0.0764 U_{10N}, \quad (94)$$

with roughness recovered as $z_0 = 10 / \exp(\kappa_{\text{vK}} / \sqrt{C_{DN}})$. Stanton and Dalton numbers follow the stability-corrected LY04 parameterisation.

Ocean Dynamics

Boussinesq Hydrostatic Primitive Equations

In vector-invariant form on the cubed sphere:

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = (\zeta + f) v - \frac{\partial K}{\partial x} - \frac{1}{\rho_0} \frac{\partial p'}{\partial x} + A_h \nabla^2 u + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \left(A_v \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} \right) - w \frac{\partial u}{\partial z}, \quad (95)$$

$$\frac{\partial v}{\partial t} = -(\zeta + f) u - \frac{\partial K}{\partial y} - \frac{1}{\rho_0} \frac{\partial p'}{\partial y} + A_h \nabla^2 v + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \left(A_v \frac{\partial v}{\partial z} \right) - w \frac{\partial v}{\partial z}. \quad (96)$$

The Coriolis force is split: depth-mean $f\mathbf{v}$ in the barotropic substeps, baroclinic shear $f\mathbf{v}'$ in the slow tendencies.

Tracer equations (skew-symmetric)

$$\frac{\partial \phi}{\partial t} = \frac{1}{2} \left[-\mathbf{v} \cdot \nabla \phi - \nabla \cdot (\phi \mathbf{v}) \right] - w \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial z} + K_h \nabla^2 \phi + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \left(K_v \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial z} \right). \quad (97)$$

Free-surface equation

$$\frac{\partial \eta}{\partial t} = - \sum_k \nabla \cdot (h_k \mathbf{v}_k). \quad (98)$$

Barotropic Solver (Forward–Backward, Semi-Implicit Coriolis)

The barotropic system is solved with split-explicit forward–backward substeps:

$$\frac{\partial \eta}{\partial t} = -\nabla \cdot (H \bar{\mathbf{V}}), \quad \frac{\partial \bar{\mathbf{V}}}{\partial t} = f \hat{\mathbf{k}} \times \bar{\mathbf{V}} - g \nabla \eta + \mathbf{F}_{\text{slow}}. \quad (99)$$

Semi-implicit Coriolis. With $\alpha = \frac{1}{2} f \Delta t_s$:

$$\bar{U}^{n+1} = \frac{R_u + \alpha R_v}{1 + \alpha^2}, \quad \bar{V}^{n+1} = \frac{R_v - \alpha R_u}{1 + \alpha^2}, \quad (100)$$

where $R_u = \bar{U}^n + \alpha \bar{V}^n - \Delta t_s g \partial \eta / \partial x$ and $R_v = \bar{V}^n - \alpha \bar{U}^n - \Delta t_s g \partial \eta / \partial y$.

Equation of State (Wright 1997)

The ocean prognostic temperature variable T is **potential temperature** [degC]. The Wright (1997) EOS computes in-situ density directly from potential temperature θ , salinity S [PSU], and pressure p [Pa]:

$$\rho = \frac{p + p_0(\theta, S)}{\lambda(\theta, S) + \alpha_0(\theta, S)(p + p_0)}, \quad (101)$$

where

$$\alpha_0 = a_0 + a_1 \theta + a_2 S, \quad (102)$$

$$p_0 = (b_0 + b_4 S) + \theta(b_1 + \theta(b_2 + b_3 \theta) + b_5 S), \quad (103)$$

$$\lambda = (c_0 + c_4 S) + \theta(c_1 + \theta(c_2 + c_3 \theta) + c_5 S). \quad (104)$$

Coefficients follow the MOM6 implementation. The density perturbation is $\rho' = \rho(\theta, S, p) - \rho_0$.

Hydrostatic Pressure and Vertical Velocity

Baroclinic pressure by downward integration:

$$p'_k = \rho_0 g \eta + \sum_{k'=0}^{k-1} \rho'_{k'} g \Delta z_{k'} + \frac{1}{2} \rho'_k g \Delta z_k. \quad (105)$$

Vertical velocity diagnosed bottom-up from $w(\text{floor}) = 0$:

$$w_{k-1/2} = - \sum_{k'=k}^{N-1} \nabla \cdot (h_{k'} \mathbf{v}_{k'}). \quad (106)$$

Time Integration

SSP-RK3 (Shu–Osher 1988)

The three-stage strong-stability-preserving Runge–Kutta method:

$$\mathbf{u}^{(1)} = \mathbf{u}^n + \Delta t F(\mathbf{u}^n), \quad (107)$$

$$\mathbf{u}^{(2)} = \frac{3}{4} \mathbf{u}^n + \frac{1}{4} \mathbf{u}^{(1)} + \frac{1}{4} \Delta t F(\mathbf{u}^{(1)}), \quad (108)$$

$$\mathbf{u}^{n+1} = \frac{1}{3} \mathbf{u}^n + \frac{2}{3} \mathbf{u}^{(2)} + \frac{2}{3} \Delta t F(\mathbf{u}^{(2)}). \quad (109)$$

SSP-RK(4,3) and SSP-RK(5,4) variants are also available.

Robert-Asselin-Williams (RAW) Time Filter (v3.7)

The leapfrog scheme used by the semi-implicit spectral PE solver requires a time filter to damp the computational mode. The Williams (2009) modification of the Robert–Asselin filter splits the correction between the current and next time levels, restoring second-order accuracy:

$$d^n = \frac{\gamma}{2}(X^{n-1} - 2X^n + X^{n+1}), \quad (110)$$

$$X_{\text{flt}}^n = X^n + (1 - \alpha) d^n, \quad (111)$$

$$X_{\text{flt}}^{n+1} = X^{n+1} + \alpha d^n. \quad (112)$$

With $\alpha = 0.5$ (default), this is the RAW filter; $\alpha = 0$ recovers the original Robert–Asselin filter. The original RA filter introduces a first-order phase error that causes slow energy drift over climate-length integrations; the RAW modification eliminates this while preserving the same damping rate for the computational mode.

Adaptive Hyperdiffusion (v3.7)

The maximum stable coefficient for n -th order hyperdiffusion under forward Euler is

$$\nu_n = S \cdot \frac{C(n) \Delta x^n}{\Delta t}, \quad C(2) = \frac{1}{2}, \quad C(4) = \frac{1}{8}, \quad C(6) = \frac{1}{48}, \quad (113)$$

where $S \in (0, 1]$ is a safety factor (default 0.5). The function `adaptive_hyperdiff_coeff(dx_min, dt, order, safety)` eliminates manual tuning of the hyperdiffusion coefficient for each resolution and timestep.

Split-Explicit Methods

Each outer RK stage computes slow tendencies once, updates u, v and tracers, then runs N_s forward–backward acoustic substeps on the fast variables (w, θ', ρ') with substep size $\Delta t_s = \Delta t / N_s$.

Land, Ice, and Coupler

Slab Land Model

Energy balance

$$C_s d_s \frac{dT_s}{dt} = (1 - \alpha_l) SW^\downarrow + \varepsilon_l (LW^\downarrow - \sigma_{\text{SB}} T_s^4) - SH - LH. \quad (114)$$

Bucket hydrology

$$\frac{dW}{dt} = P - E, \quad W \in [0, W_{\text{max}}]. \quad (115)$$

Moisture availability $\beta = \beta_{\text{min}} + (1 - \beta_{\text{min}}) W / W_{\text{max}}$ modulates evaporation via $q_{\text{sfc}} = \beta q_s(T_s)$.

Surface humidity consistency. All slab surface tiles (land, sea ice, lake) recompute q_{sfc} from the *updated* surface temperature T_s^{n+1} (and updated W^{n+1} for land) before constructing the `TileResponse`. This ensures that the returned q_{sfc} and T_{surface} are thermodynamically consistent at the end of the timestep.

Sea-Ice Model

Surface temperature

$$\rho_i c_i \frac{h_{\text{eff}}}{2} \frac{dT_i}{dt} = Q_{\text{sfc}} - \frac{k_i(T_f - T_i)}{h_{\text{eff}}}, \quad h_{\text{eff}} = \max(h_i, h_{\text{min}}). \quad (116)$$

Growth and melt

$$\frac{dh_i}{dt} = \frac{F_{\text{cond}} - F_{\text{ocean}}}{\rho_i L_f}. \quad (117)$$

Concentration

$$\frac{dc}{dt} = \begin{cases} (dh/dt)(1-c)/h_{\text{new}} & \text{growing,} \\ (dh/dt)c/h_{\text{eff}} & \text{melting.} \end{cases} \quad (118)$$

EVP Rheology (Hunke & Dukowicz 1997)

When `dynamics="evp"`, the ice momentum equation is

$$m \frac{\partial \mathbf{u}_i}{\partial t} = \boldsymbol{\tau}_a + \boldsymbol{\tau}_w - mf \hat{\mathbf{k}} \times \mathbf{u}_i - mg \nabla \eta + \nabla \cdot \boldsymbol{\sigma}, \quad (119)$$

where $\boldsymbol{\tau}_a, \boldsymbol{\tau}_w$ are air and ocean drag, and $\boldsymbol{\sigma}$ is the internal stress tensor from an elliptic yield curve with eccentricity $e = 2$. Ice strength:

$$P = P^* h \exp(-C(1-c)), \quad P^* = 27.5 \text{ kPa}, \quad C = 20. \quad (120)$$

The elastic term provides subcycling stability ($N_{\text{evp}} = 120$ substeps).

Multi-category ice

For $N_{\text{cat}} > 1$, per-category state (h_k, T_k, c_k) evolves independently under thermodynamics, then Lipscomb (2001) linear remapping redistributes ice across thickness categories.

Land Carbon Cycle and Stomatal Conductance

DALEC-990 Carbon Pools

Six prognostic pools: labile C_{lab} , foliage C_f , root C_r , wood C_w , litter C_{lit} , soil organic matter C_{SOM} . GPP via light-use efficiency; decomposition via Q_{10} temperature sensitivity with moisture limitation.

Farquhar (1980) Photosynthesis

Assimilation rate:

$$A = \min(W_c, W_j) - R_d, \quad W_c = V_{c,\text{max}} \frac{C_i - \Gamma^*}{C_i + K_c(1 + O/K_o)}, \quad W_j = \frac{J(C_i - \Gamma^*)}{4(C_i + 2\Gamma^*)}, \quad (121)$$

where the minimum is a smooth (differentiable) function. $V_{c,\text{max}}$ and J_{max} follow peaked Arrhenius temperature responses (Bernacchi et al. 2001). Soil moisture stress: $V_{c,\text{max}} \leftarrow V_{c,\text{max}} \beta_{\text{soil}}$.

Stomatal conductance

Ball–Berry (1987): $g_s = g_0 + g_1 \text{ ARH}/C_s$.

Medlyn (2011): $g_s = g_0 + 1.6(1 + g_1/\sqrt{\text{VPD}}) A/C_s$.

Jarvis (1976): $g_s = g_{s,\max} f(\text{PAR}) f(T) f(\text{VPD}) f(\theta)$ (CO₂-independent; used when carbon cycle is inactive).

The coupled A - g_s - C_i system is solved by 5 fixed-point iterations (unrolled for JAX JIT).

Tile Coupler

Surface fluxes are area-weighted blends over ocean, land, sea-ice, and lake tiles:

$$X_{\text{blend}} = f_{\text{ocn}} X_{\text{ocn}} + f_{\text{land}} X_{\text{land}} + f_{\text{ice}} X_{\text{ice}} + f_{\text{lake}} X_{\text{lake}}. \quad (122)$$

Fluxes are time-averaged over each coupling window before being passed to the atmosphere.

Ocean albedo. The constant ocean albedo α_{ocn} is controlled by `CouplerConfig.ocean_albedo` (default 0.06). When `ocean_albedo_config.method="zenith"`, the Briegleb (1992) zenith-angle formula is used:

$$\alpha_{\text{ocn}} = \frac{0.026}{1.1 \mu_0^{1.7} + 0.065} + 0.15 (\mu_0 - 0.1)(\mu_0 - 0.5)(\mu_0 - 1.0), \quad (123)$$

where $\mu_0 = \cos \theta_z$ is the cosine of the solar zenith angle.

External forcing. Time-varying greenhouse gases (CO₂, CH₄, N₂O), total solar irradiance, and monthly zonal-mean ozone and aerosol climatologies can be read from NetCDF files and linearly interpolated in time via the `ExternalForcingConfig` interface. Ozone and aerosol data are loaded but not yet connected to the radiation solver.

Machine Learning: Spherical Fourier Neural Operator

The SFNO (ACE/FourCastNet v2 style) operates on the Gaussian grid.

Architecture

1. **Encoder:** Pointwise linear $n_{\text{in}} \rightarrow n_{\text{emb}}$.
2. **N processor blocks**, each containing:
 - Layer normalisation,
 - SH analysis $\rightarrow$ learned spectral convolution $\rightarrow$ SH synthesis,
 - GELU activation,
 - Pointwise MLP (two layers with expansion factor),
 - Skip connection.
3. **Decoder:** Pointwise linear $n_{\text{emb}} \rightarrow n_{\text{out}}$.
4. **Big-skip residual:** output = input + decoder($\dots$).

Spectral convolution

In the SH coefficient space:

$$\hat{f}_{nm}^{\text{out}} = W_{nm} \hat{f}_{nm}^{\text{in}}, \quad (124)$$

where $W_{nm} \in \mathbb{R}^{n_{\text{emb}} \times n_{\text{emb}}}$ is a learnable weight matrix per wavenumber pair.

Conservation Corrections

Atmosphere

Dry-air mass is corrected by a uniform adjustment to p_s that restores the area-weighted global integral:

$$\Delta\bar{p} = \frac{\sum_i A_i p_{s,i}^{\text{new}} - \sum_i A_i p_{s,i}^{\text{old}}}{\sum_i A_i}, \quad p_{s,i}^{\text{corr}} = p_{s,i}^{\text{new}} - \Delta\bar{p}, \quad (125)$$

so that $\sum_i A_i p_{s,i}^{\text{corr}} = \sum_i A_i p_{s,i}^{\text{old}}$ (global dry mass conserved exactly). Column moisture is rescaled: $q^{\text{corr}} = q^{\text{new}} \cdot Q_{\text{old}}/Q_{\text{new}}$.

Initial-mass anchoring (v3.7). For long AMIP/CMIP integrations, the fixer can anchor to the *initial* mass $M_0 = \sum_i A_i p_{s,i}^{\text{init}}$ rather than the previous step's mass, preventing cumulative $O(\varepsilon)$ drift over millions of timesteps. The correction becomes

$$\Delta\bar{p} = \frac{\sum_i A_i p_{s,i}^{\text{new}} - M_0}{\sum_i A_i}. \quad (126)$$

Set via `model.set_initial_mass(state)` or `anchor_mass_to_initial=True` in the config. All accumulations use float64 regardless of the state precision.

Ocean

Volume conservation: $\eta^{\text{corr}} = \eta^{\text{new}} + (\sum \eta_{\text{old}} A - \sum \eta_{\text{new}} A) / \sum A$.

Heat and salt conservation: uniform additive correction per unit volume.

Physical Constants

Symbol	Name	Value	Unit
g	Gravitational acceleration	9.80616	m s^{-2}
R_d	Dry-air gas constant	287.04	$\text{J kg}^{-1} \text{K}^{-1}$
c_p	Dry-air heat capacity	1005.0	$\text{J kg}^{-1} \text{K}^{-1}$
R_v	Water-vapour gas constant	461.5	$\text{J kg}^{-1} \text{K}^{-1}$
L_v	Latent heat of vapourisation	2.501×10^6	J kg^{-1}
κ	R_d/c_p	0.285	—
p_0	Reference pressure	10^5	Pa
σ_{SB}	Stefan–Boltzmann constant	5.67×10^{-8}	$\text{W m}^{-2} \text{K}^{-4}$
κ_{vK}	von Kármán constant	0.4	—
Ω	Earth rotation rate	7.292×10^{-5}	rad s^{-1}
$R_{\oplus}$	Earth radius	6.371×10^6	m
ρ_0	Ocean reference density	1025	kg m^{-3}

Ocean Biogeochemistry

Two schemes: abiotic (DIC + ALK only) and NPZD ecosystem.

Carbonate Chemistry and Air-Sea CO_2 Exchange

The ocean surface $p\text{CO}_2$ is computed from DIC, ALK, T , S via carbonate equilibria. Air-sea flux (Wanninkhof 2014):

$$F_{\text{CO}_2} = k_w K_0 (p\text{CO}_{2,\text{ocean}} - p\text{CO}_{2,\text{atm}}), \quad (127)$$

where $k_w = 0.251 U_{10}^2 (\text{Sc}/660)^{-1/2}$ is the gas transfer velocity [cm/hr] and K_0 is Henry's law solubility.

NPZD Ecosystem Model

Four biological tracers: NO_3 , phytoplankton P , zooplankton Z , detritus D (Fasham et al. 1990).

$$\frac{\partial P}{\partial t} = \mu_P P - G - m_P P, \quad (128)$$

$$\frac{\partial Z}{\partial t} = \gamma_Z G - m_Z Z^2, \quad (129)$$

$$\frac{\partial D}{\partial t} = (1 - \gamma_Z)G + m_P P + m_Z Z^2 - r_D D + w_s \frac{\partial D}{\partial z}, \quad (130)$$

$$\frac{\partial \text{NO}_3}{\partial t} = -\mu_P P + r_D D, \quad (131)$$

where $\mu_P = \mu_{\max} f(T) \min(L_N, L_I)$ with Michaelis-Menten nutrient limitation $L_N = \text{NO}_3/(k_N + \text{NO}_3)$ and Beer-Lambert light limitation with chlorophyll self-shading. Grazing G follows Holling-III. Redfield stoichiometry ($R_{C:N} = 6.625$) couples biology to DIC/ALK.

CMIP Infrastructure

CF/CMOR-Compliant Output

The `CFWriter` class produces CF-1.8 NetCDF4 files with CMIP6 Data Reference Syntax (DRS) filenames: `<var>_<table>_<model>_<expt>_<variant>_<grid>.nc`. Two CMOR tables are provided: `Amon` (21 atmospheric variables) and `Lmon` (6 land variables).

Experiment Templates

Six CMIP6-style experiments with built-in GHG time series:

Template	Period	Forcing	CO ₂ range
<code>piControl</code>	1850–∞	Fixed 1850	284.3 ppmv
<code>historical</code>	1850–2014	Transient	284→397 ppmv
<code>ssp245</code>	2015–2100	SSP2-4.5	397→600 ppmv
<code>ssp585</code>	2015–2100	SSP5-8.5	397→1135 ppmv
<code>amip</code>	1979–2014	Prescribed SST	Transient
<code>1pctCO2</code>	1–150	1%/yr increase	284→1277 ppmv

Restart and Reproducibility

Each restart file is accompanied by a `.meta.json` sidecar containing: SHA-256 state digest (sorted, concatenated array bytes), SHA-256 config hash, platform identifier, JAX version, x64 mode, and git hash. The function `verify_reproducibility()` compares two restart files and reports any discrepancies.

Tuning Guide

A registry of 16 tunable parameters across five categories (dynamics, radiation, convection, diffusion, surface) with valid ranges, default values, sensitivity ratings, and physical notes. `validate_tuning(config)` checks CFL consistency, range violations, and conflicting options. `recommended_params(resolution, nlev)` provides resolution-appropriate defaults.

4D-Var Data Assimilation (v3.9)

The model includes a fully differentiable 4D-Var data assimilation system that exploits JAX's automatic differentiation to compute exact gradients of the cost function without hand-coded adjoints.

Cost Function

The 4D-Var cost function minimised over the assimilation window $[t_0, t_N]$ is

$$J(\mathbf{x}_0) = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{x}_0 - \mathbf{x}_b)^T \mathbf{B}^{-1}(\mathbf{x}_0 - \mathbf{x}_b) + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^N (\mathcal{H}_i[\mathcal{M}_{0 \rightarrow i}(\mathbf{x}_0)] - \mathbf{y}_i)^T \mathbf{R}_i^{-1}(\mathcal{H}_i[\mathcal{M}_{0 \rightarrow i}(\mathbf{x}_0)] - \mathbf{y}_i), \quad (132)$$

where $\mathbf{x}_b$ is the background state, $\mathbf{B}$ the background error covariance, $\mathcal{M}_{0 \rightarrow i}$ the nonlinear model propagator, $\mathcal{H}_i$ the observation operator at time t_i , $\mathbf{y}_i$ the observations, and $\mathbf{R}_i$ the observation error covariance. Gradients $\nabla_{\mathbf{x}_0} J$ are computed via `jax.grad` through the full forward model trajectory.

Control Vector

The control vector comprises perturbations to:

- Horizontal wind components (u , v),
- Temperature (T),
- Specific humidity (q_v),
- Surface pressure (p_s).

Increments are applied in model space and can optionally be preconditioned by the square root of $\mathbf{B}$ (i.e. $\mathbf{x}_0 = \mathbf{x}_b + \mathbf{B}^{1/2} \boldsymbol{\chi}$ with minimisation in $\boldsymbol{\chi}$ -space).

Background Error Covariance

Four background error covariance formulations are implemented:

1. **Diagonal:** $\mathbf{B} = \text{diag}(\sigma_b^2)$, the simplest variance-only model.
2. **Diffusion:** $\mathbf{B} = \boldsymbol{\Sigma} \mathbf{C} \boldsymbol{\Sigma}$ where $\mathbf{C}$ is a correlation matrix defined implicitly via iterated Laplacian diffusion on the model grid.
3. **Spectral:** $\mathbf{B}$ is diagonal in spectral space, with variance specified per total wavenumber; correlations arise naturally from the spectral truncation.
4. **Hybrid:** $\mathbf{B} = \beta_1 \mathbf{B}_{\text{static}} + \beta_2 \mathbf{B}_{\text{ensemble}}$, blending a static covariance with flow-dependent ensemble covariance.

Observation Operators

Three observation operator types are provided:

- **Direct:** identity mapping from model grid points to observed quantities.
- **Interpolating:** bilinear (horizontal) and linear (vertical) interpolation from the model grid to observation locations.
- **Composite:** chains multiple operators (e.g. interpolation followed by a forward radiative transfer calculation).

Minimiser

The cost function is minimised using preconditioned gradient descent. The preconditioner is the square root of $\mathbf{B}$, transforming the problem to $\boldsymbol{\chi}$ -space where the background term becomes isotropic. The minimiser supports configurable iteration counts and convergence tolerances, and all operations are JIT-compiled.

DA Cycling and Incremental Analysis

For operational-style cycling, the analysis from each window serves as the background for the next. An incremental analysis update (IAU) option distributes the analysis increment gradually over the subsequent forecast window rather than inserting it as an instantaneous shock, reducing initialisation imbalance and gravity-wave noise.

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